

Expert report of Dr. Ilyan Varo

Scope, qualifications, and assignment

Ilyan Varo is a researcher retained to explain institutions and reporting practices in the Republic of Kalyra. The assignment is limited to the period from January 2021 through June 7, 2024 and to three questions: how Directorate Unit Four receives information, how Harbor League contractors interact with municipal officials, and what ordinarily happens when a local officer is named in a complaint. The report does not decide whether A.R.M. is credible or whether the legal standard for CAT protection is satisfied.

Varo's qualifications include twelve years studying public-procurement controls, regional security commands, and complaint-routing systems. The file contains a curriculum summary, a list of prior consulting engagements, and the compensation agreement. Counsel supplied the pleadings and selected exhibits, but no party dictated the conclusions. Every factual statement identifies its source class and confidence limit.

Method and source hierarchy

The report uses four source classes. First are published Kalyrian directives and budget tables, which reliably show formal structure but not necessarily field practice. Second are municipal register extracts and routing logs authenticated by their custodians. Third are interviews with former employees, coded to protect confidential identities and tested against dates or documents. Fourth are press and civil-society summaries used only when at least two independent items describe the same event.

Varo distinguishes a verified document from an inference. A verified routing code may establish where a complaint traveled; it does not by itself establish what every recipient knew. Interview accounts are reported with material inconsistencies rather than harmonized. No numerical torture probability is assigned. The analysis instead identifies pathways, overlap, and evidence that makes a pathway stronger or weaker.

Government structure in Merrow Province

Kalyra's formal system divides national registry administration, provincial security, municipal procurement, and civilian complaint intake. In Merrow Province, however, shared personnel and data terminals connect those nominally separate offices. Municipal identity queries are logged through a provincial gateway, and Unit Four maintains a liaison desk inside the regional registry office. The liaison desk may request travel, employment, and household-link information using a case code.

The national charter bars detention for reporting procurement irregularities. Provincial manuals also require an independent referral when a complaint accuses the receiving unit. Those rules are relevant safeguards. The available routing logs nevertheless show that the independence rule was not consistently followed in Orin Vale. The distinction between written structure and observed operation is central to this report.

Directorate Unit Four mandate and access

Unit Four is described in Directive 18 as a municipal-security coordination unit for infrastructure fraud, document theft, and threats to public systems. The directive permits short investigative holds only at registered facilities and requires a custody entry, medical screening, and notice to a supervisor. It does not authorize punishment, coercive questioning, or recovery of documents for a private contractor.

Staffing rosters place Unit Four officers at both the Orin Vale records annex and the Merrow regional command. Terminal audit samples show recurring queries for procurement clerks and their household contacts. Some queries lack a corresponding registered case. The audit cannot establish who stood behind every query, but it demonstrates that the unit had the practical ability to find a former clerk and linked family members after a return to Kalyra.

Procurement controls and invoice splitting

Orin Vale required secondary review when an invoice reached 25,000 units. The municipal ledger extract shows six Harbor League invoices—NQL-3101 through NQL-3106—each below that threshold and totaling 137,400 units. The first register version groups all six under maintenance cycle NQ-APR-A; the corrected version removes that grouping and labels each invoice an urgent standalone repair. The versions carry different approval paths, which is why the change could attract attention from a records clerk.

The report does not determine that any named vendor committed fraud. It explains why copied ledger versions could matter to officials and contractors: they reveal who approved the entries, when the grouping changed, and whether a review threshold was avoided. Nadia Pel's authentication statement supports the format of the routing and approval fields. The underlying motives remain for the factfinder.

Harbor League network

Harbor League is an association of maintenance contractors, dispatch firms, and security subcontractors. Membership lists overlap with municipal framework agreements, but membership alone does not establish misconduct. Three companies share a dispatch office with a former Unit Four logistics supervisor. Two vendor contact numbers also appear in access-request logs for the records annex.

Interviews describe Harbor League messengers as using official-looking vehicles and knowing the names of municipal complainants before those names became public. The accounts are consistent on timing but differ on insignia and uniforms. Varo treats the overlap as evidence of access and coordination, not proof that every contractor acts under color of law. The risk pathway becomes material when combined with registry and Unit Four access.

Central registry identification pathway

Kalyra's entry registry records passport scans, arrival terminals, declared destination regions, and municipal identity queries. Returnees may be flagged for a routine address confirmation. A separate witness-association flag can be added by a regional security liaison, but the policy requires a recorded case number and supervisor approval.

Audit excerpts show that liaisons sometimes used generic infrastructure case codes that did not identify an open matter. Once a flag exists, a regional notification may reach Unit Four before a traveler leaves the terminal. The report cannot say that A.R.M. presently has such a flag. It can say that A.R.M.'s prior municipal role and household links are data fields available to the same regional network involved in the complaint history.

Office of Civic Integrity intake protocol

The Office of Civic Integrity receives written complaints through municipal counters and a central portal. Its manual requires staff to preserve the original, assign a neutral intake number, and send allegations against security personnel to an external review desk. A complaint against a contractor may be sent to municipal procurement unless it also alleges official participation.

Complaint **OCI - 23 - 441** was accepted June 7, 2023 under initial route **IC - 2**, a valid independent- conduct intake pattern. The June 9 audit links it to procurement referral **CIV - 23 - 184** through employment code **ARM - RX - 14**; the June 10 destination changes to **RC - 4**, Merrow regional command. The June 30 status remains “regional response pending.” Nadia Pel explains that staff were instructed to use that command route when a complaint mentioned protected infrastructure. The protocol therefore sent the matter back to officials implicated in the allegation even though the written manual called for separation.

Complaint outcomes in the sample

Varo reviewed forty complaint entries from Orin Vale during the source period. Twelve named security personnel. Of those twelve, nine were routed to a regional command, two went to the external review desk, and one was returned as incomplete. None of the nine regional referrals contains an interview entry for the complainant. Four contain a notation that the named unit reported no policy breach.

The sample is too small to estimate a national rate and was selected because routing data were available. It nevertheless tests the claim that a formal complaint automatically produces independent protection. In this municipal sample it often did not. The report does not infer the outcome of a complaint merely from a blank field; it notes where the file closes without the steps the manual describes.

Formal prohibitions and enforcement evidence

Kalyrian law formally prohibits torture, unregistered detention, retaliation against procurement reporters, and disclosure of complaint identities. The Ministry of Justice publishes annual discipline totals and operates an inspector hotline. Those safeguards are genuine parts of the conditions record and weigh against a categorical claim that no official remedy exists.

The same annual tables combine minor paperwork violations with serious abuse findings and omit the originating unit. Provincial records show few referrals from the inspector hotline to an outside prosecutor. Varo therefore treats the prohibitions as relevant but not conclusive. The question is whether they function for a person whose complaint is routed to the same regional command and whose identity can be queried through that command's liaison.

Detention practices attributed to Unit Four

Former municipal employees described questioning at two sites: a registered regional interview room and an unlisted storage compound near the records annex. Accounts concerning the compound share details about a metal interior door, overhead machinery noise, and the absence of a custody receipt. Dates span 2022 through early 2024. Two witnesses described demands for copied procurement records; another described questioning about a contractor protest.

No interviewee identified A.R.M. by full name, and the report avoids constructing such a name. The consistency supports a practice-level inference but does not prove A.R.M.'s particular two-night detention. Medical observations, family testimony, and A.R.M.'s own account must be evaluated on their own foundations. The conditions evidence supplies context for whether the described method is plausible and officially connected.

Monitoring of procurement witnesses

Municipal circular 7-C instructs supervisors to preserve access logs when an employee reports an invoice irregularity. A separate security appendix permits monitoring when copied records are classified as infrastructure-sensitive. Neither document authorizes threats. In practice, the classification decision is made by a municipal-security liaison without an adversarial hearing.

Three former clerks reported home visits after copying ledger material. Two received written requests to return documents; one reported only an oral demand. The cases differ in seriousness, but each involved a registry or household query shortly before contact. This pattern supports a possible information chain from municipal records to security actors. It does not establish that all whistleblowers are detained or that return alone triggers harm.

Internal relocation

Kalyra has no formal internal-passport barrier between provinces, and large cities offer anonymous short-term lodging. Those facts could reduce exposure for a person known only to local actors. They are less protective when central entry records and household links are part of the asserted chain. The registry gateway permits a regional liaison to query a new municipal address after a service registration or formal job application.

Varo identifies practical distinctions rather than deciding legal reasonableness. Avoiding public employment and registered housing could reduce discoverability but would also limit lawful work, health care, and ordinary residence. The report has no evidence that Unit Four conducts continuous nationwide surveillance. It finds only that relocation does not sever every pathway described in the record.

Combined pathways and overlap

The three asserted sources are not independent boxes. A registry notification can identify a returnee; a Harbor League contact can supply a household or workplace lead; Unit Four can use official access to detain or question. Counting those as three separate events would exaggerate risk where they lead to the same encounter. Ignoring the links would understate risk where one actor enables another.

Varo maps the shared nodes: identity data, regional command routing, vendor contacts, and the prior procurement complaint. The map contains no percentage and no legal conclusion. Its purpose is to show which evidence bears on a combined chain and which evidence is genuinely distinct, such as a separate threat delivered to S.M. outside the family residence.

Protective response and duty to intervene

Formal responsibility for an unlawful detention lies with the provincial inspector, municipal police, and the external review desk. The available records show no independent interview after the June complaint and no request for the clinic source described by the family. The routing audit ends June 30 with status “regional response pending” at Unit Four regional command.

This evidence may bear on awareness and response, but it does not prove the mental state of every official. The report separates actual receipt from constructive awareness and avoids equating bureaucratic delay with consent. The strongest evidence is the directed routing to the implicated command combined with the absence of an independent interview or recorded response through the audit cutoff.

Events after A.R.M.'s departure

The source period includes threats reported to S.M., continued vendor access to municipal work, and registry queries connected to the family residence. It does not include facts or materials arising after the June 7, 2024 source cutoff. No later event is inferred from the patterns described in this report, and the report addresses only the sources available when it was signed.

Varo identified no reliable report that Unit Four disbanded or lost registry access before the source cutoff. A revised complaint circular was announced, but implementation records were not available. The absence of a documented reform is not affirmative proof that practices remained unchanged. It is recorded as an uncertainty relevant to how much weight to give older incidents.

Limits of inference about A.R.M.

The report does not authenticate A.R.M.'s copied ledger, diagnose injuries, determine that a detention occurred, or decide credibility. It accepts the asserted facts only to identify whether the conditions evidence would make them institutionally coherent. It also does not infer that a person who reports corruption necessarily faces torture.

Specific limits include incomplete provincial discipline data, coded interview identities, and a source cutoff fixed without awaiting an adjudicative ruling. The Harbor League evidence shows contacts and access, not a universal command structure. The registry evidence shows capability, not a present flag. These limits remain material even when the pathways are considered together.

Cross-examination disclosures

Counsel paid a fixed fee of 4,800 dollars for research and testimony, regardless of the result. Varo has testified in six protection matters, four for applicants and two for the government. One prior report was criticized for relying too heavily on translated press accounts; the present report therefore identifies each translation and requires corroboration before drawing a practice-level inference.

The underlying interview notes are not attached because disclosure could identify former employees who described official systems and expose them to retaliation. Counsel received a redacted source-correlation table listing interview dates, source codes, collection methods, translation status, and corroborating documents. Varo retained the complete notes and will produce them under an appropriate protective order if directed. Cross-examination may address source selection, missing data, formal protections, alternative explanations, and the distinction between institutional capacity and a predicted event.

Source register

The source register identifies SR-01, Directive 18 issued in 2021; SR-02, municipal circular 7-C; SR-03, the Civic Integrity intake manual; SR-04, provincial discipline tables for 2021 through 2023; SR-05, terminal-audit samples through June 7, 2024; SR-06, the forty-entry complaint sample; SR-07, vendor framework lists; and SR-08, coded interview summaries. Each entry states the issuing or custodian office, date and version, acquisition method, original language, translation status, and any authentication limit.

Materials supplied by A.R.M.'s counsel are marked separately from those collected by Varo. The register links each report proposition to at least one control and identifies whether the support is a formal rule, an observed record pattern, or a coded account. Where a source is incomplete or its provenance cannot be independently confirmed, that limitation appears beside the control rather than being resolved by inference. The register and redacted correlation table permit the parties to test the report's formal-authority, access, routing, contractor-overlap, and practice claims through objection and cross-examination.

Declaration and signature

Varo declares that this report states the opinions held within the assigned scope and that the materials, methods, compensation, contrary information, and material limitations have been disclosed. The conclusions may change if an authenticated external-review file, registry flag history, or provincial discipline record supplies contrary evidence. No undisclosed model, confidence score, or prediction about the tribunal was used. The complete notes and source controls will be preserved through the conclusion of the proceeding.

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct to the best of my knowledge after reasonable inquiry. Executed on June 7, 2024. Ilyan Varo, retained expert in Kalyrian public-procurement controls, regional security institutions, and complaint-routing practice. Service and professional communications may be directed through retaining counsel. The source register, redacted correlation table, curriculum summary, prior-testimony list, and compensation disclosure are incorporated into this twenty-page report. Admission and weight remain for the immigration judge after objection and cross-examination.